

TRUSTMRR STARTUP DATASET

Inside TrustMRR: What Actually Makes a Startup's Revenue Grow

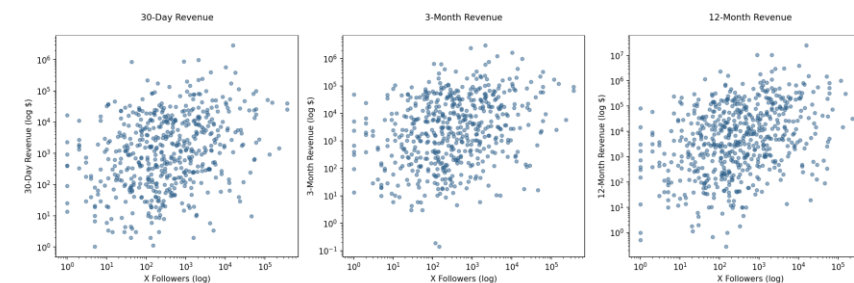
What we learned from 1,000 startups — about followers, paying subscribers, where the money concentrates, and who's in this market

Source: MU_Session_3_TrustMRR_1,000-Row_Dataset (frozen 30 Jul 2026)

Prepared for stakeholder review

A big following is not a big revenue signal

We compared follower count to revenue across 1,000 startups, at three different time frames (last 30 days, 3 months, and 12 months). In every case, the two barely move together — a bigger following just doesn't predict bigger revenue.



Followers vs. Revenue, across all three time frames

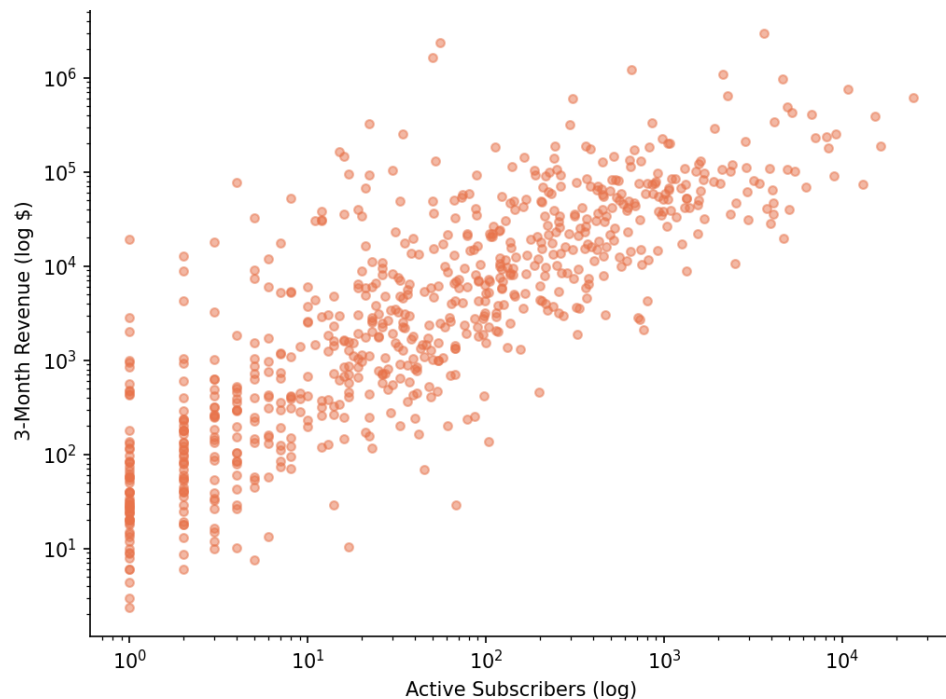
Virtually No Connection

Between follower count and revenue — at every time frame we checked

Stan and Brand On Demand — two of the dataset's very top earners — built revenue with comparatively modest followings, while several large-audience accounts monetize poorly.

WHAT THIS MEANS: A big social following looks impressive, but it doesn't tell us how much money a startup will make. When evaluating a startup, focus on how it sells and prices — not how many followers it has.

Paying subscribers are what really drive revenue



Active Subscribers vs. 3-Month Revenue

Unlike followers, the number of paying subscribers a startup has closely tracks how much revenue it makes. A small number of huge outliers can hide this pattern at first glance — but once you look past them, the trend is clear and consistent.

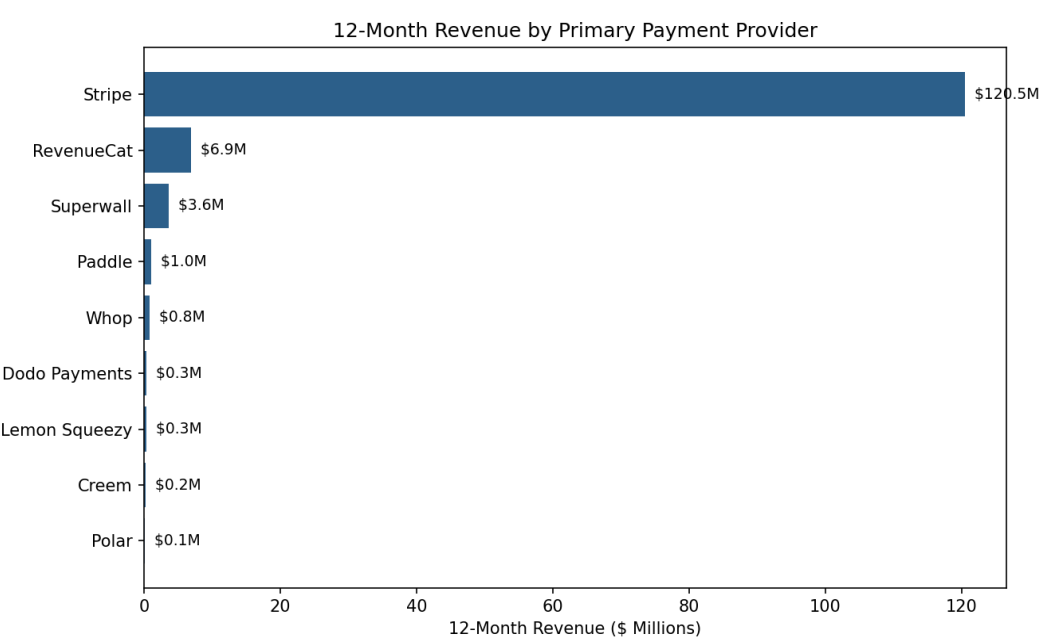
Strong, Reliable Link

Between subscriber count and revenue — the clearest pattern in the whole dataset

But two startups with the same number of subscribers can still earn very different amounts — because what they charge each subscriber matters just as much.

WHAT THIS MEANS: Paying subscribers are the best single sign of how much a startup earns. But pricing matters too — it's why two startups with the same number of subscribers can end up in very different places.

Revenue concentrates by platform — and by company



12-Month Revenue by Primary Payment Provider

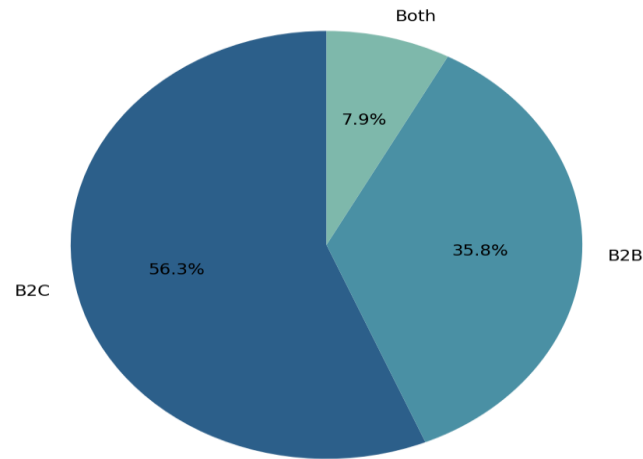
Provider	Startups	12M Rev.	% Total
Stripe	644	\$120.50M	90.1%
RevenueCat	191	\$6.85M	5.1%
Superwall	19	\$3.60M	2.7%
Paddle	16	\$1.03M	0.8%
Others (5)	130	\$1.77M	1.3%

Stan, Brand On Demand, and Stack Influence rank in the top 10 no matter which time period you look at — steady performance, not a one-off spike. Several unnamed “Stealth Company” entries also appear near the top.

WHAT THIS MEANS: A small group of platforms and companies bring in most of the money. Which payment provider a startup uses matters less than which startups are actually on it.

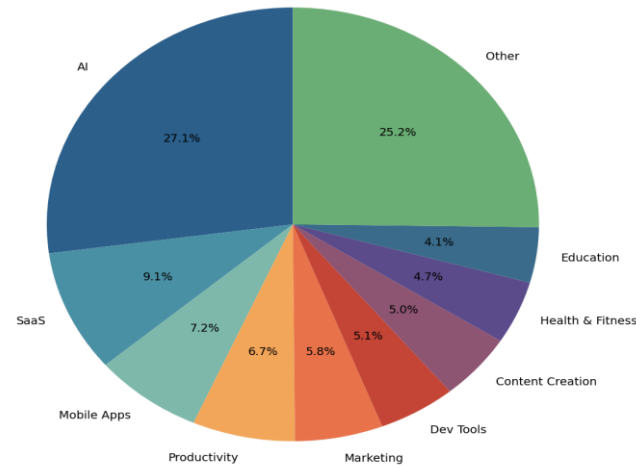
A global, AI-led, consumer-leaning ecosystem

Startups by Audience Type (B2B vs B2C)



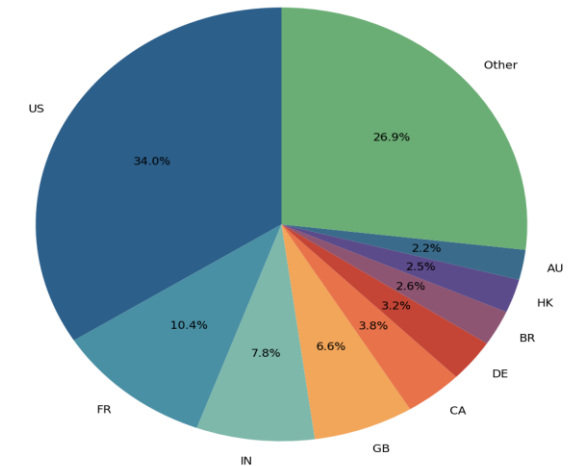
Audience: B2C 56.3% · B2B 35.8% · Both 7.9%

Startups by Category (% share)



Category: AI 27.1% (~3x SaaS at 9.1%)

Startups by Country (% share)



Country: US 34.0% · FR 10.4% · IN 7.8% · GB 6.6%

WHAT THIS MEANS: Most startups in this dataset are AI companies, based in the US, and selling to everyday consumers. Keep that in mind when comparing any single startup to the “average” one.

Followers don't predict revenue — paying customers do

- Follower count tells us almost nothing about how much a startup earns.
- Paying subscribers are the strongest signal we found — and pricing explains the rest.
- A handful of platforms and companies bring in most of the money.
- Most startups here are AI companies, based in the US, and sell to consumers.

BOTTOM LINE

When judging a startup, look at how many people are actually paying and what they're charged — not how many people follow it. And expect the biggest winners to be AI companies based in the US.